

ROUGHLY EDITED COPY

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION - UMASS BOSTON
PUT YOURSELF ON THE (CAMPUS)MAP
MARKETING YOUR PROGRAM ON CAMPUS
JANUARY 18, 2018, 3:00 P.M.

REMOTE CART PROVIDED BY:
ALTERNATIVE COMMUNICATION SERVICES, LLC
www.CaptionFamily.com

This is being provided in a rough-draft format. Remote CART, Communication Access Realtime Translation, is provided in order to facilitate communication accessibility and may not be a totally verbatim record of the proceedings.

>> CART writer is standing by.

>> Good afternoon, everyone. Hopefully everyone is getting settled in and can hear me speaking now. I got a message that said they can hear anything and it was because we weren't talking yet. Welcome today. My name is Rebecca Lazo, I'm the knowledge translation associate. And I would like to thank you for attending. You see from the screen it's called putting yourself on the campus map. And our presenter today is Amy Dwyre D'Agati who is with the University of Maryland and is a technical assistance provider. So thank you again and thank you Amy for being our speaker today. A few technical items before we get started. Obviously we are using the zoom platform which is new for us in the past few months. You should see a chat panel on the side and be able to see who the attendees are and ask questions and raise your hand and things like that. I will be monitoring that, the chat today, while Amy is presenting. If you have questions for Amy or me, technical assistance problems, let us know. Just put something in that box. Today we are live captioning our webinar. If you need to access that, you can use this URL right here that I put in the chat box. If you would like to access today's PowerPoint, it is on our website. If you need a hard copy or something that you can make notes on, so that link is also in the chat box. I think that's about it for now.

I will be putting a poll up at the end of the webinar to get some feedback on how we did serving your needs and meeting your expectations. Please stay tuned for that and in the meantime I will turn it over to Amy.

>> Okay, thank you. Can you -- am I heard?

>> I can hear you, yes.

>> All right. You will be my test on that. Great! Thank you so much. We will go ahead and get started.

Today -- and a lot of you will probably recognize this information because it's what you have heard in terms of job development you may have heard it from me about how to market yourself to employers in order to create more opportunity for jobs. But what I realized in working on college campuses is programs that I helped coordinate and programs I supported is that we often need to take a step back and take some of those strategies on marketing and getting your information out and do it right at home on our campus. We tend to forget to do that we get on campus and then go ahead and let's go out to the world of work and start networking and I found sometimes that the people on our own campus don't really know fully who we are in our program. Why we are there or they hear a little bit about us but aren't quite sure. Everybody has a different idea. So I wanted to talk today about as you are getting started on campus in the first couple of years, making a really solid concerted structured effort to let people know who you are and market yourself on your campus community to really get yourself embedded on campus. So as we go to the next slide.

So as we all know for the transition programs that students of intellectual disabilities on the college campuses, there is a bunch of goals we have for even having these programs, but really in the big picture our goals are inclusion, like really bag full part of the campus community. Access, access to all parts of the campus. Opportunity. I mean, the reason anyone goes to college is to open more doors than you would have had if you weren't there. It's a whole, you know, community of new people to network with that will lead you to places to go. And obviously careers, our goal is to get a better job than if you didn't go to college and a lot of that is part of the networking in opening more doors to opportunities. In order to do that, we really need to be -- well -- well-known on campus and need to know many

people on campus. Whether you are a small campus or a big campus. As many people as you can know will really help out. All of these things, this inclusion, access, opportunities, better careers, it doesn't happen without effort. So I think we need to really be systematic about how we open these doors and how many doors we can open. That's really what I want to talk about today. So we just -- I can't move the slide. Thank you.

So we need to start at home. On our home campus. And gone are sort of those days where we snuck on to campus and that is lucky. But I know I started some programs way before TPSIDs and higher Ed really embraced these concepts and a lot of what we were doing is sneaking on campus. And you had one contact and you kind of quietly got on and then slowly, you know, talked to certain people in that -- and not others because you were afraid you might kick off and might lose your space and all of that stuff. I think we have learned over the years that's really not the most ideal way to become fully included on to a college campus. And now that we have the concept of post secondary programs for students with intellectual disabilities isn't quite as bizarre as it was 15 years ago. And we are starting for those of you who had funding you actually had to get partnership buy-in to start which is great. And now I think we need to really embrace the fact that we are there and we are there and offer a lot to the campus community and we should be known and should talk to as many people as possible. So think about what your program, who do you know how many people do you know on campus. How many contacts do you really have on campus? And is it a variety? How many different departments are represented in your contacts? So I want everybody to kind of think about how many of you feel you are well-known on campus, your program, and how many of you think you have the right -- the people have the right understanding. They haven't heard this word of mouth. Oh, yeah, we heard of that program but they aren't sure what it is. I have gone on to campuses where like a program is known because one of their students was arrested and that's not what I'm talking about. That's not -- for the right reason. That's being infamous. So we want to talk about being known on campus and being able to control that message so that everybody has the right understanding of what it is that you do there that you are not separate. That you are part of the campus and you considered students. All of those little things that if you do word of mouth or nothing is really formalized, you no control over what people are thinking you are doing on campus. What they are telling other people what they are doing on campus and whether

they care that you are on campus if they are not fully understanding, yeah, what do I have to do with them when there are a lot of ways they can partner with you. So it's all about controlling that message. So we need to step back and look at how are we a part of this campus community.

As we know with job development, the more people we know obviously the more job opportunities we have available to us and the more options we can offer our students. It is the same for marketing on a campus. The more people that we know and can partner with on campus, the more we can create different, unique opportunities for inclusion, access and expanded careers which is really, really our goal and if our other goal is to individualize this and have the students running and planning on what they are doing on campus, the more opportunities we can create the better it can match somebody's individual interests and the more unique an experience it can be for each of the students. So it takes a little bit of effort to go ahead and to do that and to expand all of our knowledge about what is available on campus and even if it's a small campus, I am -- I am constantly amazed when I would work with or provide T.A. for programs that are on little campuses how many different diverse, cool clubs and departments and sports and other athletic clubs that they have that if you didn't really investigate you may not know and it made me think, I probably missed a ton of stuff when I was in college. If I had really explored more. That's really our job in running these programs is to explore what is really going on and offer that to students. And because our programs are a little unique, we have to be clear about who we are and what we can offer to each of these unique programs and opportunities.

So on the next slide, how do we get the word out? And I am really advocating that it be pretty systematic so there is a combination and that comes with a marketing plan and those of you who know me have heard me say you need to have a marketing plan where you are targeting your audience and you create the message to each targeted audience and it's no different here in this marketing plan you probably need to be multi-media. It's a way to control the message and it's to get it out to unique audiences. You need to do a lot of the in-person networking. We always said in job development is developing rapport. Putting your face in the place. People knowing you, recognizing you, having a personal relationship with you is really when you get stuff done. It's no different here. It's getting around campus and meeting with people personally.

And then it's really so people don't see you as you are some sort of outside group that borrows the college every now and then, but that you are really one of the team on the campus. I've seen a lot of success with those programs whose staff and students join committees, clubs, planning teams, become part of the vanter staff for short-term projects and are seen as somebody who contributes to the campus and as team member. Sort of embedding yourself into the community a little bit. And then volunteering your services. We can talk about examples of how you volunteer your services all across campus so you are known and that students can do some volunteering and they are known. So it takes time. Again, you don't just send out an e-mail and flier and then you are not on campus in a month. This definitely takes time. It could take a couple of years to get around but it's always -- it's also amazing for a couple of years if you don't do this, nobody will know you. No one you won't expand your knowledge base. They won't expand your knowledge base of you and vice versa unless you systematically and go out and seek it out. So it's a marketing plan. So we can talk about what are the different parts. The marketing plan. In the next slide, I think it's really important and probably heard me say this before, that you control the message so that everybody is on the same page and understands and what you want people to hear about you. Start with some targeted written materials similar to creating employer brochures that explain what it is that you can offer to a business. Target to each department on campus. It's a general introduction of your program and it also can highlight some of the different things that you have to offer each department. This is academic department. This can be athletic departments. It can be student services and clubs. It can be other contractors that work on campus that maybe provide either the child care on campus or provide some of the restaurants, the cafes, anything that's part of it and even the maintenance landscaping might be outsourced but are still part of the campus community and still opportunities for you. So you need to target those people and just let them know that it's a place for them to at least see your names, see some faces and get an understanding of why you are there and contact information so they can get more information and again letting them know what you are there on campus. What can you do to help because again all of this has got to be win-win. You want to be able to offer something to all of these different departments. So you can offer things like student workers. Interns in departments that have some gaps or overworked. Some departments might have a short-term project

from running an event to just a semester-long project. Sometimes project for graduate students that need practicum hours and they might be in fields that are supporting or working with people with disabilities once they leave so having that kind of experience while they are on campus is invaluable. So being able to offer on campus practicum hours to students are something that can be offered to certain academic departments. So there are a lot of different things that you can offer and just put it out there up front and have it written down.

Other multi-media ways -- I mean, a lot of campuses have -- are on radio station. And so maybe getting on some sort of radio show. Put -- quick 15 second commercials about you. And eventually -- might have kids that are really interested in media but great way it get an end road into having the kid work at the radio station. That kind of thing but it's also a way it get the word out and same if there is campus TV stations. If there is posters. Figuring out where do people gather and share information? On your campus culture, where does that happen and figuring out how you can be a part of that. And the key here is all of these different written materials, radio shows, all of this multi-media should have the same message so they are hearing the same thing over and over. I think that's really key that there is a singular message that is recognizable. That's part of good marketing.

The networking. Nothing really replaces the face-to-face, the relationships, the developing the rapport and put your face in the place. Just like with employers, if you can go through and set up meetings with department heads, on-campus clubs. All of the people who have the contract work that serve the campus community, and just meet. Have personal -- and I mean, it can take awhile. You can spend your whole first year just going around and meeting people, but the pay back on that is huge. And it also -- it says here as for referrals, once you meet somebody, a lot of times you will talk and you should really talk with Joe over in this department. We've worked together on a couple of projects and he might be really interested and then that's an easy end road. Easy to call up Joe and say, you know, professor Jones, I was meeting with him and we were having lunch and he mentioned your name and thought it would be a good idea. Joe is not going say no. He is like, oh, great, a friend of a friend. So you really can get far with that. So that's something -- and that does take time and again when you are meeting with folks and you are talking about your program, it's again the same message.

You will get into a lot more detail when you are one-on-one with somebody, but the opening the start of that is still the message that is in all of your multi-media. Networking and making appointments.

On the next slide, one of the strategies that we always used with job development is something called informational interviews. You are really going in with the purpose and you are trying to find out certain information about each department. So when you meet with somebody, you have some good questions to ask and you are really trying to find out what is the main purpose and the function of each of these departments. What is their history on campus? How long have they been around. How are they viewed? What are some of their needs? How are they structured? You will be amazed on a campus just because there are two different academic departments done mean their structure isn't all the same. Doesn't mean that culture is the same. So trying to get an idea of the feel for each department that you are going to work with. You want to know who the key personnel. Who is it really important to know in these different departments or contract businesses or athletics or whatever you are meeting with. Who else do they know? They will lead you to referrals that will make your life a lot easier when they connect you to people and if they -- if they know another person and they can see how you would help them, that's a great help as well. And the whole time that you are doing that and literally taking notes and asking questions, you doing more listening than talking in all of these because you are trying to gather as much information as you can, you are figuring out the whole time ways that your student can participate. And not just even the current students that you have this is a great tool for sustainability because the more people you know you know, next year somebody comes in and you never had a kid interested in media and suddenly a kid comes in and who loves me or wants to -- and is obsessed with radio, well, you don't have to start from scratch. You have done radio commercials. You met with the head of the student radio department. You have met with the professor who leads the radio -- you can just go to your buddies that you met with you are already developing relationships so that as you are getting students in, new student and they have interests that you had before, I already know somebody. I know somebody who can help you with this because you met with them. It's great when you have those ah-ha moments either way. A student comes in with an interest and you have to find them or you already been talking to professor for awhile and then a student comes in with that

interest and you go oh, my God, that's a great match. All of the work eventually pays off even if you don't have anyway to partner at that time I bet in a year or two years and you absolutely will and it's already been put into motion. Which is great. Another reason to just get yourself known on campus.

Here is what I was talking about becoming embedded on campus. Because again, you don't want to be seen as an outside entity, as a group that just comes and goes. You want to be seen as yet a partner on campus. A part of the community. A part of the team. So joining some department committees, it's possible -- and it all depends on how you are on campus. Who your contacts are. Sometimes programs come in through say the departments of education. And that is where your main contact is. That's where you have gotten a lot of your supports. That's where you used the copy machine. Whatever it is, you are a part of that department. So if they have a committee for anything coming up, volunteer to be on that committee. Sometimes there is a celebration planning. As simple as going to holiday parties and planning those things. Helping with any sort of student services, then your name is known as staff people and it's much easier to then develop partnerships with people that you have been on a team with. The other option is leading or helping with clubs. Any hobby or talents that you have yourself -- hobby or talents that you have yourself that might be supportive. I worked with some campuses. One western Connecticut State University or one of the teachers was just -- loved photography anyway and became like a co-leader for the photography club. Brought in a student or two. And then with mixed with students from all around -- mixed with students all around campus so all of the students got to know him because of the photography club and that was helpful and really embedding in there. If you want to help with one of your students or you have a hobby or talent, that you could lead other students with. And sometimes that's easier on smaller campuses than bigger. Depends on the culture and the more people you know.

The other thing is event support. Sometimes they need volunteers to do concessions for the smaller sports. I guess if you are at a big 10 school that's covered, but not always. And say there is on campus there is the 100th anniversary of the campus. There is all sorts of celebrations going on for that whole year and yourself and your students be a part of the committee for a festival they are putting on or for bringing in speakers or whatever it is that they are having. Be a part of

that so that again people see you and say, well, they are giving on campus. They are a part of just like everybody else which is really our goal for inclusion.

And then offer any services you have. I knew some programs here in Maryland where the teacher offered once a month, I think it was Thursday evening they were running out of their career services they would have teachers who are around, professors, review people's résumés before say the career fair was coming up. So they would have a certain number of résumés and student would come in and review and say I would make these changes and whatever and she offered her time some once a month she would go in and it wasn't her students whose résumés. It was matriculating students on campus but then she was also able to let her students put their résumés in and become a part of that process once a month. But first she volunteered to do that or to be a speaker in a career services at a fair that they are running. So offer yourself up because you have expertise on that campus. If they see the expertise that you have as a staff, you know, they will recognize that this is a win-win and we can partner. So trying to become embedded on campus. Again that takes time but that's thank puts you at a whole other level and gives you a higher level bargaining. You want more bargaining chips as you create more opportunities and they know you are a part of campus.

>> Amy, it looks like there is a question from somebody that just put her hands down there was somebody that was asking a question. I don't know -- where did you go? Friend in the audience who had at question. You can type something in the --

>> Chat box or, I can pull up the Q&A box, too.

>> Maybe she will raise her hand again. Meantime, here you go.

>> Thank you.

Anyone who heard me talk, I talk strongly when we are working with employers who are trying to find jobs, that concept, standard marketing concept of features to benefits. How to teach our students about their fors and how to benefit a business. And job developer your features and your support benefits an employer. It is no different here. You need to know your -- what are the features of your program and how they benefit the campus community. And it's -- these are points that can go in

your written materials. These are points that you verbalize during informational interviews, any time you are talking so that people understand the positives of you being there. So you have to think about what are some of the features of your students. What are some of the features of your program that are marketable. That sell you. So part of your features is your career focused. You are working on creating workers, students who have the skills and the understanding and the soft skills to be good employees and to launch a career. That's really what you are focused on. That's a feature of your program. It's also that you have a diverse population. These are some unique learners and that's a positive. That's one of the features of you being there in college campuses are often focused on diversity. Another feature is that you are there. You as your staff. You are -- your talented staff that offer additional support. You have talents that could support career services. You have talents that could support clubs. You have talents that could be -- could help with mentoring and taking -- grad students who need practicum that you can help support. There are all sorts of features of you as a talented staff that can really benefit the college community. So these are just some examples.

Does anybody who can do this in the chat or I guess in the raise your hand box. Are there other features of your program that you can think of that you would sell? On the next slide we will talk about those benefits but what are the features that you guys have. In your program. That you think would be good to sell? Anybody wants to type in the chat box or the Q&A box. Just think of what you think you could offer to a campus. Something about you. That is unique. About your program. About your students.

>> There are no wrong answers.

>> Right. They will say wow it's surprising usually just this population of people don't go to school and inclusion and awareness, absolutely. I was going to say this population doesn't typically go to school. You are right. These are really motivated students who worked really hard to be here. And, right, inclusion and just general awareness. We are trying -- college students, we are trying to get them ready for the world. That's the purpose of college. Or world is leaning toward inclusion of all types of people. And you are right, we are adding to that. We are definitely adding to that. Yeah, collaboration faculty for new teaching methods. I love that.

Internship opportunities in our organization, there is a good swap. If you have students who are going to be graduating from there and want to work in this field, hey, they were working with you and internship opportunities at your organization. Whether that is at the state organization, whether that is the agency that you work for. That's great. That's a great swap of resources. They love that one. Totally stealing that one. Those are great. Those are great features that you have. And now let's go on to the next slide and take it one step further. Don't tell them what you are good at. Tell them why what you are good at is so beneficial to this company. What's your value at? Why are all of these features so important to the campus. How do your students and the programs benefit all of these partners -- practicum hours. I see that coming through the chat box. Absolutely.

Students workers supporting your student workers but also mentoring opportunities or practicum hours -- practicum hours for the graduate students or undergraduate students who need experience with working with students with disabilities. Who need experience doing counseling, one-on-one work. You totally can offer that. That's a total benefit and it's easy and it's on campus. Sometimes they have to partner with agencies that are way off campus and figure out the transportation and you are right here on campus. There is mentoring opportunities for students on campus. Which is a benefit for a lot of students. You can also set up -- I know sometimes we have done this where there is work study that you can be an entity on campus that is part of the work studdie somebody is becoming a mentor and doing one-on-one counseling and that kind of thing they can get paid through work study to do that so you are another entity offered for work study and that's a benefit as well. Supports teaching diverse learners which somebody had said for new teaching methods. Help professors and other students understand universal design in teaching and understanding -- I mean, at Think College there are a lot of articles and information and information when talking to professors where they said this was so helpful in my classroom. It taught me so much and my students so much that it really was a benefit. And just adds diversity again generally to campus life and a lot of colleges have diversity. It's huge in their mission. And it's becoming more and more so.

I got another one up here on the webinar chat. Relationship building critical for all college students. Yes! And those relationship building skills for students -- sense for other

students who need to understand and engage with others. Absolutely. This is what we need to get across to campuses and this kind of marketing can do this, is that our presence on campus is beneficial to the typical matriculating student as well. The things that they can learn from diversity, relationship building, partnering or really life skills that just make for better graduates. And so getting that information across is really important. And anything else? Any other ways that you see yourself examples that you have seen already happen or ones that are popping into your head ways that you in your program benefit your college campus? Stuff that you see maybe for those of you that have been around for a little longer and stuff that happened organically and I always say that it happened organically for a reason because you probably had done some good marketing and because you had -- your face was in the place. That's when stuff happens.

Universal design with faculty and students. Is a great -- is a great benefit that you support. Right, helping others to see the person before the disability. Removing the stigma. Absolutely. And it's interesting to see because when I go and sometimes speak on college campuses, I ask students, you know, nowadays did you go to school with students with disabilities in your classroom and more and more are saying they are raising their hand. Inclusion. Yeah, it's not so surprising for young people to be going to school, high school, you know, and elementary school with kids with disability. So it's not a surprising for them to see them on college campus. It's becoming easier and easier to work with this population and then if you take it one step further it's not weird for them to go to work with. The people that they just gone to school with and they gone to college with. So that's an important.

Anything else? Any other ways you feel like you have benefited on campus? Either big universal ways you helped or even just a small one-on-one? I heard so many examples of working with the students on campus who have then changed their minds about their career because of the work that they have done with your program. You changed the life of somebody or they focused -- they want to be a lawyer but now they are focusing on disability issues. Or they are going to be a doctor but now they are much more aware of how disability affects medical services because of the experience that they had. Being able to make people more aware and make them better at whatever career, whatever career they will go into, they will come across people

with disabilities. If you can shape, you know, more knowledge for those people that really when they do graduate, they are better and more inclusive. I mean, you have done the campus a huge service. This is the kind of information. If you don't go and talk to people and say this kind of stuff, they aren't going to realize that. So it's really important to get that across.

If there is any other, just type them in if you think of them. And let's go on to the next slide and I want to talk about things to remember when you are systematically doing this kind of marketing on campus. It's really important that you share the same message. Because there are a couple of you going around talking to people and students. Make sure you are saying generally the same thing. Understand what your mission is and understand why you are there. And it is -- it seems so basic. We should say the same thing that it's also the most common marketing mistake that companies make. The mixed message, the confusion so nobody really knows what they are supposed to -- if someone is confused they won't make the effort. I think it's important that you know what your message is and again is that systematic approach to marketing. Everybody sit down and talk about how we are going to do this. Who will cover this. Who will go to the radio station. What's your goal? Here everybody has the same materials that we are working from. Everybody has the same questions you will ask on your informational interview. It's just -- you will have a stronger message and you will get the right information back. And we have a bunch of people saying stuff up here. Love it. One program said we keep the adaptive education classes in high demand and make sure the classes are free from cuts. And giving advice to future teachers. Again, yes. If they are -- if it's a campus and it's a college that is training teachers, we need to send them out with much more information about our population than they would get if you weren't there. Absolutely. That's really important. And like I said, in any field you will work with people with disabilities. But if we can really get our teachers better trained with more practical experience, that's huge.

Back to the slide, let your students be the face of the program so as you are meeting with people doing informational interviews, take students with you as you meet people on campus. They are the whole reason you are there. It teaches them about interacting with people and it's going to make people on campus really comfortable. No different from anybody else. It really helps the whole program in general. And it introduces them to

the students that they might be working with. It's good to keep them as a face of the program. Make sure your partnerships are win-win. We talked about what you have to offer. Make sure it's clear that you are not just there trying to get things from everybody and, oh, poor us. Help us out. But what it is you have to offer. The concept of win-win negotiations. And you have a lot it to offer. We just talked about that so making sure that you are clear about that. You are going into offer things to departments that will benefit them just as what they are offering to you will benefit your students so that's great.

Few more things to remember. Not everyone will respond to you in the same way. That's okay. It's human nature. Just be prepared for that there are some people who still think you shouldn't be there or you say it over and over and interpret who you are and what you are doing there in the wrong way. And those are just the people you don't partner with. We have learned in these programs is that is the exception to the rule. What's good marketing and really explaining what you are doing and being a part of the campus, most people recognize how beneficial it is to have you -- what a great thing that it's appropriate that access and inclusion are necessary, you know. But you will have the outliers, old school professors, on the verge of retirement anyway. It's going to happen and just move on. I used to get angry and -- you know, just move on. You are not -- there are some people that don't waste your time trying to change their minds. It's okay. Work with those. The majority of the people are going to get it. But just be prepared. There are always a few.

And then expand your partnerships through testimonials. We are talking -- you start talking to somebody and they enjoy working with you, they are going to tell other people. That's the best way to get an in. Not you trying to give them the mad sell, but one of your partners saying, oh, my God, I had this great experience and let me connect you with this program. That's the strongest sell you can ever have somebody speaking for you. That takes time but it will happen more often. The more people you know the more off the than will happen. They are going to recommend new people. Talk to your existing partners. And it's just going -- it can snowball. Just get in there once you get in there it will feel slow in the beginning. Like, hi, nice to meet you. Whatever, and then all of a sudden you will start getting calls from -- oh, hi, I was speaking with so and so and recommended I talked with you. And you will have so many

appointments that you will be super busy meeting everybody on campus. It makes it more fun and I will say it to you, it's more fun for you on campus because I know it's hard -- these post secondary programs if you are from a school system, suddenly you are like hanging out there. You don't have a principal. You don't have the building administration supporting you. You are out there on your own and it feels lonely and nobody -- the back ever the system who really knows what you are doing. And you lose that sense of family that happens when you are a teacher in the school system. You just have to -- you will create your family right there on campus so it's your college community. Makes your job so much more fun. And then of course the more people, the more opportunities that your students have and the cool things that are going on to make it more fun for them. It's the same. Makes it more fun for any college student. 240 there are those college students that go and take advantage of stuff on campus and have a very different experience than those who go to class and don't do anything else and do nothing extracurricular and don't discover stuff on campus. That's on those students. And that's sometimes the personality thing. In our case with our students the visibility sometimes we have to facilitate the stuff and that's what we are there for. So there is -- you will have the students who don't want to access of what you discover. But you know what? You will have students who for the first time they are not seen as the special Ed kid. There is no special Ed at college. You open up all of these opportunities and they are willing to work with you and they will realize I don't have a label going in here and -- you see kids that suddenly become a new person when they have been pulled away from, you know, 16 years of special Ed. So you know, you open up all of these opportunities and do all of these -- you create these cool partnerships and everybody benefits. So it makes the whole experience so much more fun and also the goal then is to get these kids jobs as they are graduating. Anybody graduating from college. But once you have done this, now you have -- you have contacts who have know of jobs. You know? And you just have more opportunities to develop jobs on campus that lead to better jobs off campus. It makes your job development so much easier as well. Start with what you can control and seems more manageable which is right on campus and then it will expand to beyond that. Yeah, and somebody just -- oh, and Ann Marie, yes, I agree keeping new faces in front of existing partners re-enforces the value and longevity of the inclusive initiative. Like the we are not going away. I love that. We are not going away actually you will realize you don't want us to go away. Actually very helpful

and we are really in an important part of this campus. And I think -- you are right. Longevity, sustainability.

If you are embedded on a campus there, it's much harder for them to get rid of you and they don't want to. Comes to the end of your funding and they are like, what do you mean? We have to figure out a way for you to stay because you are so helpful here. We really enjoy you because you have so many partnerships, what would we do if you went away. We have to find a way to keep you here. So just even in terms of that, there is really no downside to marketing yourself on campus.

So that's all have there if anybody has any other questions or comments, I don't think any of this was rocket science by any means but I do just my experience of going on campuses everybody was focused on let's do networks for job development and I realized we didn't know enough about our own campus and campuses didn't know enough about us. Just taking all that we know and we are good at and take it a step back and do it back here at home.

Any questions.

This is a big expectation thing. Hi, Jean. Changing expectations of what students are capable. Absolutely. That's our job. You will change the expectations and the understanding of the population for a whole slough of graduate students that are going out into the world of work. I think that's important as well. And again, nothing -- none of this is overnight this much is something that you would do piecemeal and then you will start to reap the benefits. You won't even know, you know, all of the benefits that will come of this. But suddenly your job after a couple of years will become easier.

How do you talk about disabilities in marketing materials? Whoa, that could be whole another webinar. Because everybody has to be what you are comfortable with. I have known people who have job developed who have -- who don't ever mention the word disability and then I know people who are good job developers that open with disability. So I think it's just being honest. We aren't trying to hide anything. And I think sometimes the more you are embedded on campus the easier it is to talk about disability because you can use just examples with students that they know so that they understand it's just doing something a little differently. It's just a diverse learner. And understand that there is a bunch of diverse learners on campus.

That could be a whole webinar and people have different opinions and you have to go with what you are comfortable with and how you present disability. I do think as a rule when you are doing your very first initial introduction with somebody, I wouldn't open with disability because you haven't had enough time to control the message yet. And sometimes you put out the word disability in the first 15 seconds, and you have no idea what that person thinks of disability. They might have a child with a disability that is working or they might not. They might have no experience with disability and they go to severe disability. They don't understand -- the only experience they ever had is the mental illness with disabilities. That's all they go to. You lose control of the message. So I think with more time and that's why it's the personal networking and the controlling of the message that by the time you are talking about disability, it's been controlled and you can explain yourself and you can take questions about it and you can give examples as opposed to just open with disability. You lose control early and you may not get people back. That's the only rule I go by is timing on when disability is mentioned and they typically -- I don't typically open with it. That could be a whole another disclosure. Whole another webinar.

>> I will make a note. Does anyone have any other questions sort of even if they are not specifically on the topic but related? I don't know -- is there any particular time, Amy, that it's good to start marking. I mean, some people on this call may have had programs that are in existence for awhile? And others are just at a initial planning stage.

>> I would say tomorrow. No matter where you are. Start tomorrow. Because it can't hurt if you are new, it's easier when you are new because you can say, hey, we are new on campus. And if you have been around, great, now you have a lot of examples of stuff you have done. Let me give you some examples. Here are some of the people we worked with. It just changes your message a little bit. Yeah, tomorrow.

>> Okay. Tomorrow. So I don't know if you noticed there is another question.

>> I just saw that. One of our students wants to join a student group and our initial reaction is to reach out and share information about our program, disability etiquette and et cetera

there are plenty who would rather not have affiliation. Anyway of balancing that outreach.

>> Yeah, yeah that outreach approach. That's an individual student thing and that's why sometimes it's good to be known as a program but not necessarily as a disability program because sometimes a student will need supports but not necessarily because of a disability. And you would just have -- just make it -- you will be able to facilitate that so you have to go with students' desires. And sometimes what will happen is the student will try to get in and don't talk to them. I will do it on my own and they realize they are struggling and want you to come in. So that -- you have to figure out what your message and what a student has been in there and now approaching. But that's why sometimes it's great if you already gone around and -- you have talked to the head of all of the student clubs and they are aware and when a student does come in without having to freak out or ask about disability and go, oh, I think this is a student, part of this program, awesome. And if I -- you know, I talked to John Smith. If I have any questions I know who to go to on their own. It's just you are now just a resource and it wasn't like a big thing of let me walk in and talk about disability before I join this program. You are already known on campus and they might know who you are and it's organic. That's another benefit to just kind of being known and, cool, you are here on campus with us. And then it makes someone joins a club and cool, it's just from -- yeah, one of these guys. No problem.S in anyone else? Anybody else have any future webinar ideas that we can ask Amy to do for us? Any other needs related to this sort of program advertising and getting students involved on campus and getting other buy-in and partnership going? We are happy to take requests or suggestions.

>> Absolutely.

While we were waiting for people to do that, in case anyone needs to hop off to attend another event, I'm happy to have anybody do this poll if they need to leave for another meeting or something. This is with regard to today's webinar. There is a few questions here that I would love for you to answer. Amy, it does look like there is one other question in the box there.

>> What are relationships like with college accommodations offices. So varied. And I think that's a really sensitive one because you want to have a good relationship and oftentimes

unfortunately there is not. We support people but not your kids. So that's one of those -- if you went in and offered services to that office, because obviously you are experts in accommodations and they have students not in your program who need accommodations that you can help support, so being a partner before you even throw support in for your students in there. It depends on your disabilities support services office. Some I have seen have great relationships and others don't want anything to do -- you handle your own program as opposed to we want our students to access what's existing here and they think, why, you are here, why do you need us? It's just another more -- so if you can support them so that they feel like, oh, they are helping us, less work for me, then maybe you might get -- you might be able to really partner with them. Maintaining partners with student group and student leadership change year to year and that's the same topic when you get a kid a job and then that mid-management level and they move them up to Ohio and they move them -- or whatever and you lose your manager. It's that same concept. It's the person you bonded and totally understands and is suddenly gone. How do you embed yourself more in the system instead of just the one person you sold. Yeah. That's a grant money for the program. That's always a good one. If I can help with that.

Accommodation for student life. How do you accommodate students that are participating in something other than academic or job. It's like having those accommodations just for hanging out. And that's where the more you are embedded and the other students are comfortable with you, the more enable that becomes.

Parent issue with student not wanting to work. Will that issue not ever go away? 25 years of doing this and sounds like there is a parent that doesn't want his kid to work. Sometimes we have to market to parents the same way we market on campus and to employers. And they changed their ideas and expectations. That's on an individual basis but that will always happen. There is always going to be a -- getting a job and the parent goes, oh, no I don't want them to have a job. So frustrating.

>> Do they not want them to get a job ever or not get a job while attending classes on campus?

>> Probably all. All kinds. Again, all. Don't want them to work or not work because they are getting -- get any benefits -- SSI, there is fear. All sorts of things.

>> Well this has been a really helpful webinar today and I don't know if anyone else hasn't taken the evaluation we would be happy to have you weigh in Amy, do you have anything else to add today? I don't know, other resources people might be good to tap into or -- anything else?

>> I would just say stick with those things. The things to remember that if you can apply just basic marketing strategy to all that you do, you will get far. And we tend to forget because it's just that I'm talking to people on campus. That's marketing. And make sure that when you talk to people on campus you have that same message and you are certainly talking about benefits. And so that it will be natural. So we think marketing is so that I'm not a sales person. It's not in sales. You know what? You kind of are. You know all of the time and that's okay. And you know what? As teachers you are good at it. And you are really passionate about these programs and that makes the best sales people so if you can just remember that and we just forget to mark -- we forget networking with people we know. We go, oh, I have to find, he wants to be a vet and I have to search in the yellow pages -- do you have a vet? Do you have a pet that you -- we forget to go to our own -- what my husband does. My sister is in the field. We forget the stuff that's obvious and close to us and that's why we forget to market on campus.

>> Great ideas I think today from you and the participants. I just want to thank everyone for being here and thank Amy for her time. Please note that future webinars and events are posted on the Think College website. Our next event is on February 15 and it's a webinar on inclusive dual involvement and how to capitalize on those experiences when doing IET planning. And we are taking registration now. And the recording of this webinar and a transcript will be available on the event page for this webinar. And if you have any questions, just reach out and e-mail Think College TA at Gmail.

>> So thank you, everyone.

>> Bye, everyone!

>> Bye-bye.